HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# My Plan for Replacing "I have to hide my struggles from other Christians"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

"I have to hide my struggles from other Christians." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ What am I hiding?
- ☐ What has hiding cost?
- ☐ Who is safe?
- ☐ What will I say?
- ☐ What do I need in response?
- ☐ How will I follow up?

My own question: _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ We are meant to carry burdens together.
- ☐ Confession and prayer lead to healing.
- ☐ Light brings fellowship.
- ☐ Hiding keeps wounds hidden.
- ☐ Safe people exist.
- ☐ I can share wisely.

In my own words: _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- ☐ James 5:16
  *"Therefore confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed. The prayer of a righteous man has great power to prevail."*
- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  *"Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."*
- ☐ 1 John 1:7
  *"But if we walk in the light as He is in the light, we have fellowship with one another, and the blood of Jesus His Son cleanses us from all sin."*

A verse I found myself: _____

# Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Brought into the light: Each week, record one step in sharing a struggle with a safe person.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  *For example, James 5:16 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can confess and pray with others so that I may be healed.""*
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Confession" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

*Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.*

- [ ] Name the struggle. Write what you are hiding.
- [ ] Choose wisely. Identify one person known for confidentiality and grace.
- [ ] Share briefly. Tell part of it and see how they respond.
- [ ] Ask for prayer. Request regular prayer or check-ins.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I have to hide my struggles from other Christians": _____ % My truth: _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | Brought into the light |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

| Day | Song I listened to | What it told me that challenges the lie |
|---|---|---|
| Mon | | |
| Tue | | |
| Wed | | |
| Thu | | |
| Fri | | |
| Sat | | |
| Sun | | |

## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I have to hide my struggles from other Christians.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Lord, I have been carrying this alone. Lead me to a wise and trustworthy person with whom I can share. Heal me through Your people, and use my honesty to help others. Amen.*

*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*